

kind of updates are mandatory for all users, even those using Windows 10 Pro.

Then come upgrades. Windows 10 will occasionally release updates that bring new features and functionality to Windows. While this is great for people who want it, it isn't generally what people expect from their OS. If people bought Windows 7, and were one day pushed a build of Windows 8, because that's the direction Microsoft wanted to go in, then they would be rightly upset. They would be even more upset if they had no control over this decision.

Of course Microsoft has put systems in place that prevent such a thing from happening. They have something called the Insider track which we shall talk about shortly.

A lot has been said about how only Windows 10 Home users are forced to install upgrades, but this isn't entirely accurate. Windows 10 Pro users can choose to delay upgrades, but eventually, in a few months they will be forced to upgrade Windows.

Of course there will be tools available to block updates and upgrades. To make sure that there is a better sync between Microsoft and its customer base, Microsoft now has as constant pool of beta testers who have access to upcoming features before release. Microsoft calls this their Insider program, and we'll talk about it in more detail shortly.

However here is where the kicker comes in, blocking updates makes your OS unsupported, and that might not be a desirable option for everybody.

As we mentioned upgrades are also cumulative. This might be obvious, but each upgrade will build on the previous one, which means you cannot install a newer upgrade without installing the previous one. Again this is quite obvious, but it has a negative effect as will become clear.

The final point is that when Microsoft says that Windows 10 upgrades will be free for the lifetime of a device, it's really important to understand what they mean by lifetime. If you install Windows 10 on a device, and over the course of a few years Microsoft releases an upgrade that brings changes to Windows that increase its system requirements, or changes that conflict with your hardware, then your system cannot upgrade.

Since updates are cumulative, you might be locked out of not only future upgrades to Windows, but also future security patches. At this point of time your device has reached the end of its 'lifetime' of support.

Windows Insider

With new upgrades to Windows coming out constantly Microsoft needs